

UK and Commonwealth Tanks (cont.)

British tank doctrine, dating back to the mid-1930s, required two types of tank. Cruisers such as the Cromwell were intended for independent action and needed to be fast—however, this limited the amount of armor they could carry. Infantry tanks such as the Valentine, on the other hand, operated alongside footsoldiers: they could be slower, but needed thick armor. Britain also used US tanks, some of which were modified.



◁	Valentine Mark IX
Date	1942
Country	UK
Weight	19 tons (17.3 tonnes)
Engine	General Motors 6004 diesel, 138 hp
Main armament	QF 6-pounder gun

The most-produced British tank of World War II, Valentines were used in North Africa, the Pacific, and in Eastern Europe. Highly versatile, it formed the basis for many specialized variants, such as a bridge layer, Duplex Drive amphibious tank, and flamethrower.



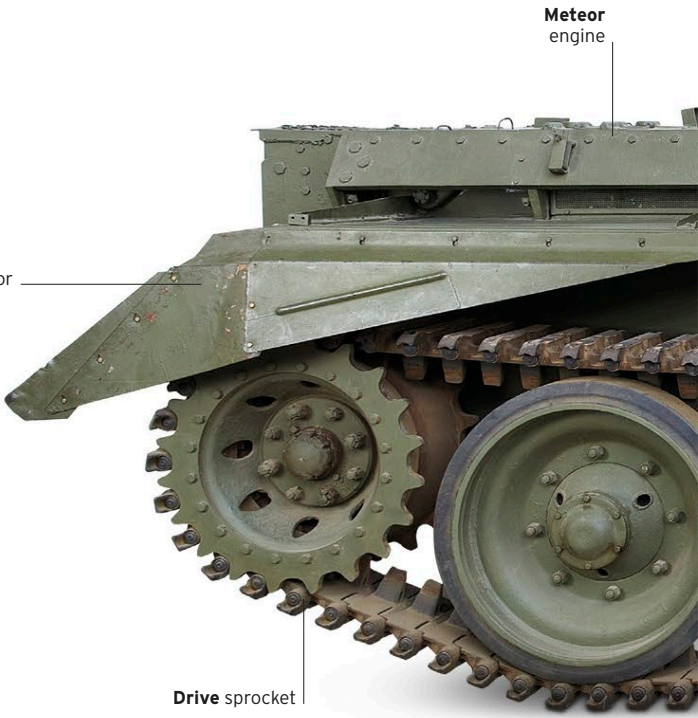
▽	Churchill Mark VI
Date	1943
Country	UK
Weight	44.8 tons (40.6 tonnes)
Engine	Bedford 12-cylinder gasoline, 350 hp
Main armament	QF 75 mm gun

After extensive upgrades and improvements for better reliability, the Churchill Mark VI was very different from the Mark I (see pp.92-93). It was now armed with a 6-pounder or 75 mm gun, and its armor protection was greatly improved. It was renowned for being able to climb seemingly impossible hills, and for shrugging off antitank fire.



△	Harry Hopkins
Date	1943
Country	UK
Weight	9.5 tons (8.6 tonnes)
Engine	Meadows gasoline, 148 hp
Main armament	QF 2-pounder gun

The Harry Hopkins, as it was known, was a larger and better armored variant of the Tetrarch (see pp.78-79). It used the same unusual steering technique, where the road wheels moved sideways and twisted the tracks. Unlike the Tetrarch, it was too heavy to be airlifted and saw no service.



6-pounder main gun